

1756

SEVEN YEARS' WAR BEGINS

Colonial rivalries between France and Britain, and unresolved issues from the War of the Austrian Succession, erupted in 1756 in a conflict fought on land and at sea around the world – in India, North and South America, the Caribbean, Europe, and West Africa. The end of the war in 1763 left Prussia as a major European power and Britain with the upper hand in North America and India.



△ The British army at Quebec

1758 Halley's Comet returns, proving Edmond Halley correct in theorizing that comets orbit the Sun

1757 Muhammed III stabilizes Morocco after 30 years of unrest and curbs the Berber pirates

1758 The Al Sabah dynasty takes control of Kuwait after the chieftains of the Utub confederation make Sabah bin Jaber emir

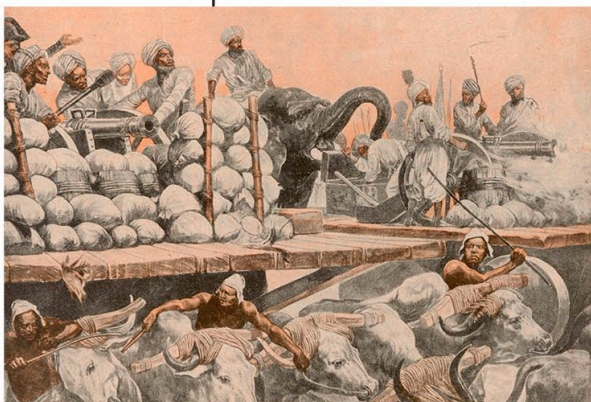
1759 Suppression of the Jesuits begins in European colonies amid suspicion of their power and loyalty to the Pope

1759



△ An Allegory of the Victory at Quiberon Bay

▽ The nawab's forces at Plassey



1757

NAWAB OF BENGAL DEFEATED AT PLASSEY

On 23 June, a force of the British East India Company under Robert Clive defeated the Nawab of Bengal's much larger army at the Battle of Plassey. The victory allowed the British to take control of Bengal and then expand the Empire over much of the subcontinent.



**1725-74
ROBERT CLIVE**

A British general and administrator, Clive was a controversial figure. He established British control over Bengal but was accused of corruption and exacerbating the devastating famine of 1770.